

Personal Branding



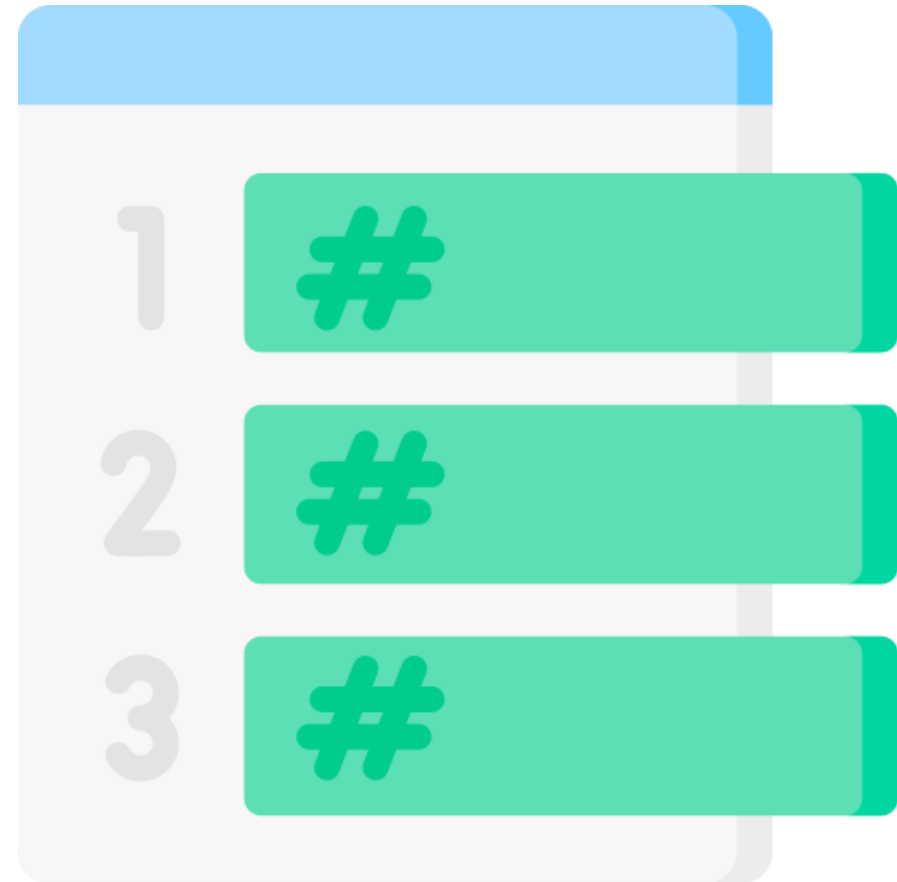
Session Learning Objective:

By the end of this session, participants will learn how to:

- 1 Define personal branding and recall the four pillars of a powerful personal brand (A · C · E · V).
- 2 Explain why personal branding matters for freelancers and how client reviews reflect a person's brand.
- 3 Apply the five-dimension framework to set branding goals and choose the right platforms for your brand.
- 4 Analyze profiles and content samples to spot strengths and gaps against the ACEV pillars.
- 5 Evaluate AI-generated brand content and refine it for authenticity, consistency, and your own voice.
- 6 Create a personal branding starter kit: an elevator pitch, a visual identity draft, and a one-week content plan.

Key topics covered:

- Understanding Personal Branding
- The A·C·E·V Brand Pillars
- Define Your Goals
- Design Your Brand
- **AI Activity: Craft Your Elevator Pitch**
- Create Your Visual Identity
- Choose the Right Platform
- Build Your LinkedIn Profile
- Develop Your Content
- **AI Activity: One Idea, a Week of Content**
- Discover Your Community
- Networking and Effective Communication



Why Personal Branding?



Think of your favorite brands.

What makes them memorable? What value do they provide, and how do they communicate it?



You are a brand too.

Just as products and services must be branded to communicate their differentiators and attract customers, you can craft your brand through a practice called personal branding.



What is Personal Branding?

“

Personal branding is the practice of crafting and communicating what makes you **unique** — your values, your skills, and your personality.

Just like products are branded to attract customers, you brand yourself to **attract opportunities**.



What people will say about you when you are not in the room

The deliberate way you communicate your value, strengths, and professional identity - consistently across interactions and platforms.

PROMISE

What you want to be known for

PROOF

Evidence that supports it

PERCEPTION

What others actually remember



Brand Evidence: What Clients Notice

Your brand is already visible in the words clients use about you.

PROFESSIONALISM

How you show up and communicate.

EASE OF WORKING

How simple and respectful the experience feels.

RELIABILITY

Whether your delivery matches the promise.



echoac

Canada

★★★★★ 5 | 4 months ago

very easy to work with and very professional



Helpful? ☐ Yes ☐ No



mft_author

United States

★★★★★ 5 | 3 months ago

This is my third project working with him and his team. Their professionalism, execution and communication are outstanding. The quality of their work makes it easy to continue to invest in doing projects with them. I highly recommend them as a technology solution and partner.

Helpful? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Brand Evidence: What Clients Repeat

Repeated words
become brand signals.

Communication

Understanding

Quality

Focus



w_jk13

 Germany

★★★★★ 5 | 1 month ago

Working with Muhammad and his team was an extraordinary experience that truly set a new standard for customer service and technical proficiency in my book. From the outset, Muhammad displayed an **impressive commitment to understanding** our needs,... [See more](#)

Helpful?  Yes  No



mft_author

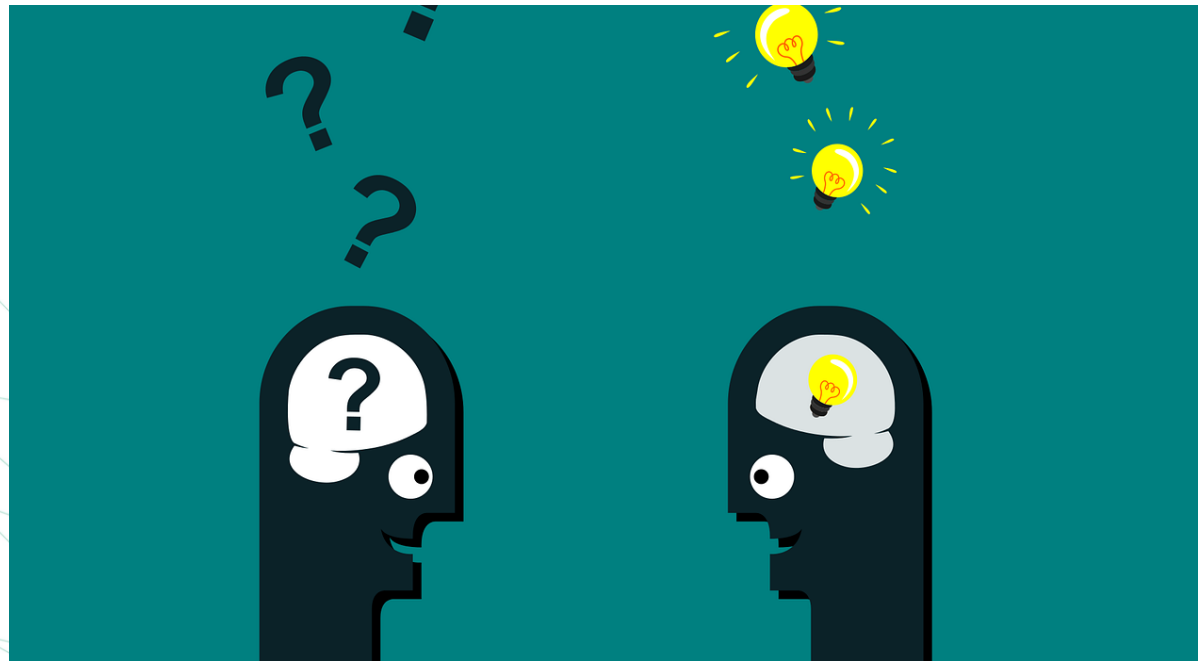
 United States

★★★★★ 5 | 1 week ago

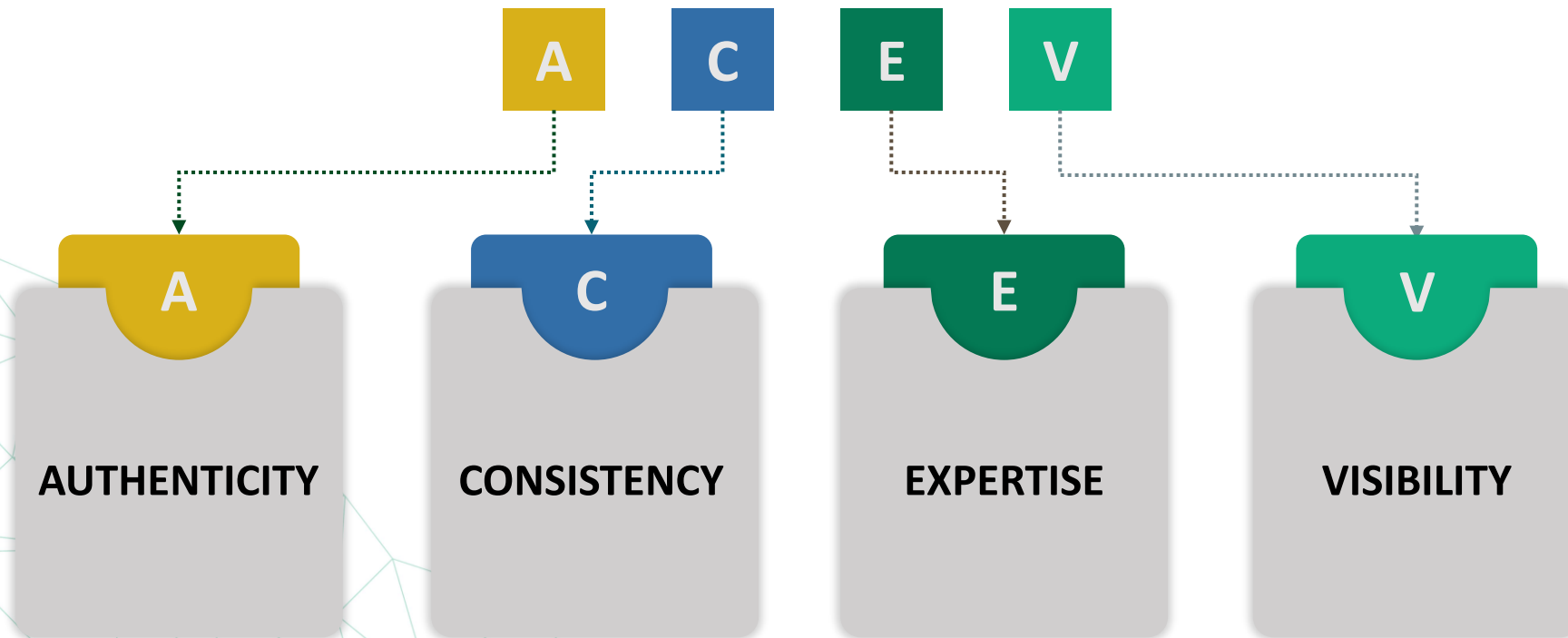
This team continues to deliver outstanding work. **I appreciate their focus on understanding the scope and details expected** of the project, their communication and their high quality results. I will continue to work with them in future releases of the project.

Helpful?  Yes  No

What makes a Powerful Personal Brand?



Pillars of A Powerful Personal Brand



Authenticity

Be true to your values, beliefs, and professional voice.

Authenticity builds trust because people can connect with a real, coherent person.

VALUES

What you will and will not compromise.

VOICE

How you naturally explain and connect.

CHOICES

The work, clients, and behaviors you repeat.



Consistency

Recognition grows when your promise, tone, and quality stay aligned.

MESSAGE

The same clear value proposition.

VISUALS

A recognizable look and feel.

BEHAVIOR

A dependable client experience.



Expertise

- Your brand should highlight your knowledge and skills.
- You position yourself as an expert by sharing insights, offering real solutions, and demonstrating your expertise (testimonials, case studies, etc.)
- Engaging with other people's content by adding value and sharing more insights is a great way to connect and further establish yourself as an authority.



Visibility

Be present where your audience already pays attention.

NETWORK

LinkedIn and professional communities

Build relationships.

SHOW

Portfolio, visual platforms, freelancing profiles

Display proof.

DEEPEN

Articles, newsletter, podcast, or video

Share richer insights.

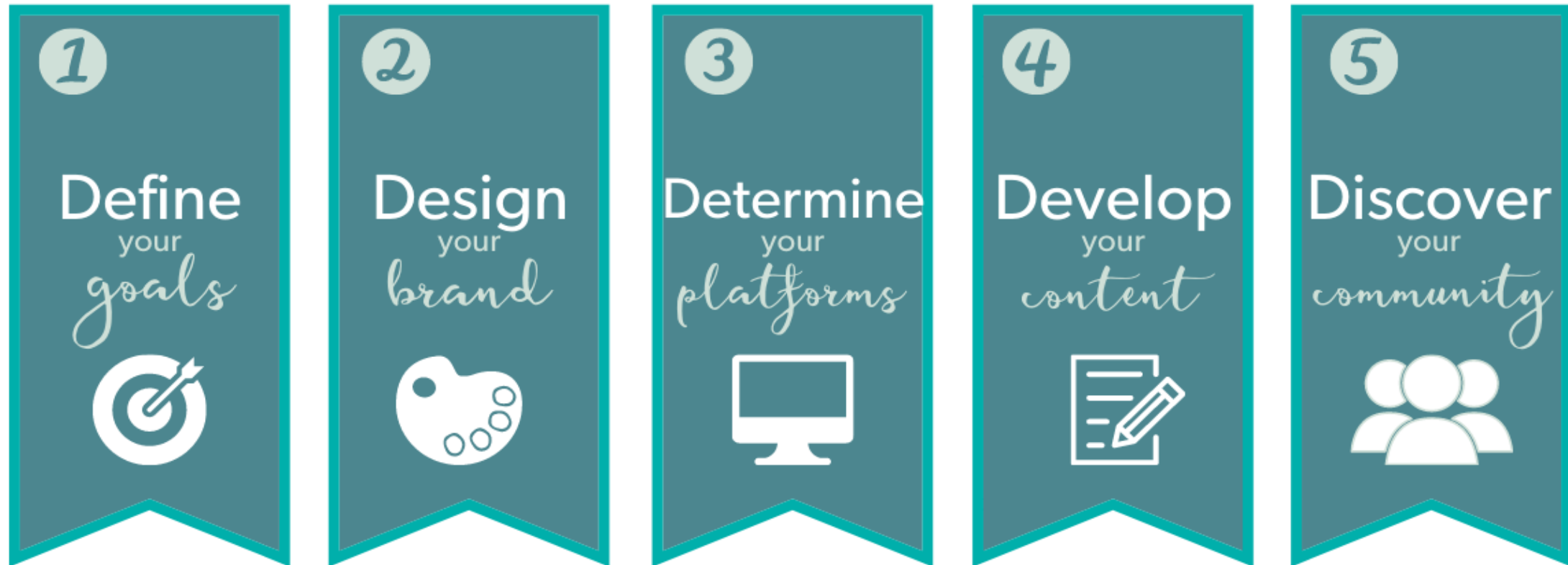


Elevate Your Freelancing Brand

Personal Branding Framework



Leanne Calderwood's Personal Branding Five Dimension Framework



1. Define your Goals

Ask yourself these questions as you work through the first dimension:

- 1 To nurture a relationship
- 2 To create a sale
- 3 To attract opportunities
- 4 To seek new job positions and roles
- 5 To contribute to the industry



2. Design your Brand

Some things you may want to amplify include:



Your personality



Your strengths



Your traits



Your passion



Brand Story



Elevator Pitch

Activity - Craft Your Elevator Pitch with an AI Assistant

1

Feed it your brand inputs

Give the AI your goals, strengths, personality and passion (from steps 1 & 2 of the framework).

2

Generate 3 versions

Ask for three 30-second pitches: one formal, one friendly, one bold.

3

Critique against A·C·E·V

Does it sound like YOU (Authenticity)? Does it match your message everywhere (Consistency)?

4

Humanize & finalize

Edit the best draft in your own voice, then read it aloud to a peer for feedback.

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

"Act as a personal branding coach.

I am a freelancer in [your field]. My goal is [goal]. My strengths are [strengths], and my personality is [traits].

Write 3 versions of a 30-second elevator pitch: formal, friendly, and bold."

✓ **Output: pitch for your LinkedIn About**

Create a Visual Identity

Elements of a Visual Identity

- Logo
- Color theme
- Language
- Typography (Font – Size)

Product (Visual Identity Guide)



3. Determine your Platform



Personal website

Your home on the internet — full control



LinkedIn

Networking, credibility & value content



Freelancing platforms

Where clients are already searching



Make your LinkedIn Profile Stand Out

LinkedIn



LinkedIn Tips

- 1 Add a professional headshot as your profile picture
- 2 Add any certifications or awards
- 3 Create a unique and relevant headline
- 4 Ask peers or professors to endorse your skills
- 5 Update your profile often
- 6 Share your biggest academic & professional achievements
- 7 Follow groups, industry professionals & companies
- 8 Use your elevator pitch as your About section
- 9 Comment and react to your connections' posts

4. Develop your Content

Content can take many forms, some forms include:



Short social media posts



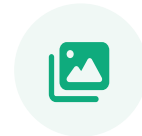
Audio content



Video posts



Long-form articles



Images & visuals

Activity - One Idea, a Week of Content — AI Repurposing Sprint

1

Pick one insight

Choose one idea from your area of expertise worth sharing with your audience.

2

Repurpose with AI

Ask the AI to turn it into: a short LinkedIn post, an article outline, and a video/carousel script.

3

Fact-check & voice-check

Verify every claim, then edit so it sounds like YOU — authentic and consistent with your brand.

4

Plan your week

Slot the 3 pieces into a simple one-week posting calendar on your chosen platform.

READY-TO-USE PROMPT

"Here is an insight from my work: [your idea].

Turn it into: 1) a short LinkedIn post with a hook, 2) an outline for a long-form article, 3) a 60-second video script.

Keep my tone: [professional / friendly / bold]."

✓ **Output: a 1-week content plan**

5. Discover your Community

You can engage with your community in several ways

1 Engage with your community via social media

2 Send engaging emails

3 Direct messages

4 Direct mentions in posts

5 Networking (virtual and in-person)



Networking



Networking is personal.

Forming a new relationship involves dedicating time to making connections.



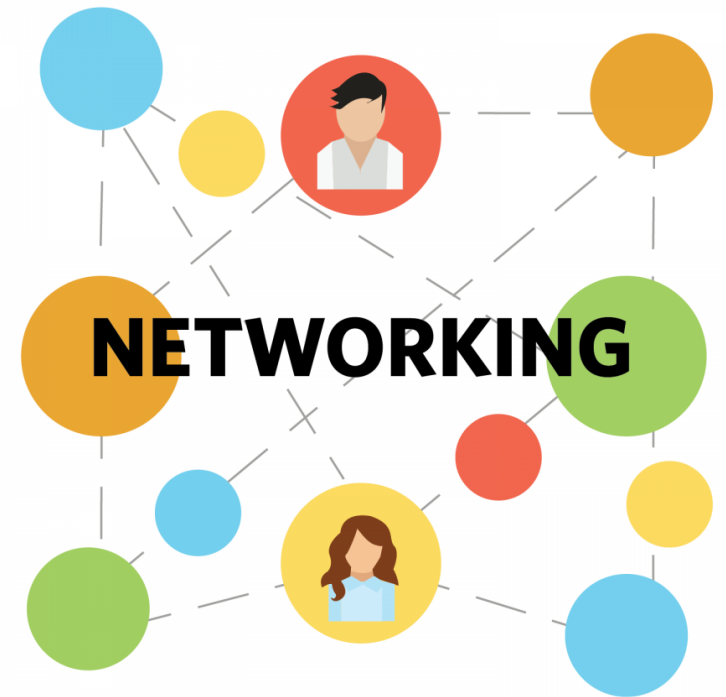
Comfort first.

Finding ways that you feel comfortable getting to know someone will set you up for success.



Find your style.

Some people thrive at large events, while others prefer networking apps like LinkedIn.



Rules for Effective Networking:



Use positive language with a touch of empathy.



Listen closely and avoid interrupting the customer.



Use consistent brand vocabulary.



Give thorough answers to technical questions.



Make communication clear and concise.

Recap

Now we know how to:

- ✓ Define personal branding and why it matters
- ✓ Define personal branding and why it matters
- ✓ Apply the 5-dimension framework: goals → community
- ✓ Use AI tools to craft your pitch and plan content



Q&A Session



Thank You!

Thank you for your participation
and attention!

